



MARKETING PLAN, GROUP 11

ABOUT PEBBLE

COMPANY'S GOAL: “Build awesome smartwatches and other gadgets, for [both the founders] and like-minded folks.”

- Pebble was originally founded in 2013, but had to shut down in 2016. This year, it's launching a **comeback with four new products ready for production!**
- Pebble has **no outside funding** apart from their initial Kickstarter campaign. The watches are sold exclusively online through its official website, store.rePebble.com, and shipped internationally.
- Pebble's software is powered by an **open-source PebbleOS**, supported by an active developer ecosystem, and setting it apart from mainstream smartwatch brands.

PEBBLE'S STORY

- Founded by Eric Migicovsky, the Pebble watch was first launched in 2013 after a record-breaking \$10.3 million Kickstarter campaign. It was a smartwatch that was designed to fulfil basic, every day functions beautifully.
- In the 4 years after Pebble's wildly successful Kickstarter, Pebble sold over two million smartwatches, cultivating a thriving community of developers who created over ten thousand Pebble apps and watchfaces.
- After shutting down in 2016 and having its IP pass through Fitbit then Google, Migicovsky relaunched Pebble in 2026. In 2025, Google decided to make Pebble OS open-source.
- Migicovsky believes that Pebble's rapid growth and feature expansion back in the 2010s made him lose sight of his initial vision.
- Despite the Pebble hardware and software support being discontinued in 2017, Pebble still has thousands of dedicated fans.

Pebble SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS

- Strong brand legacy & passionate community (Rebble.io)
- Unique value proposition: 30-day battery, e-paper display, <\$150 price
- Open-source OS & established developer ecosystem (10k+ apps)
- Minimalist, distraction-free design philosophy

OPPORTUNITIES

- Growing “digital detox” and minimalist trend
- Increasing consumer fatigue & burnout
- Underserved market gap for simple, long-lasting smartwatches
- Leveraging existing fan base for organic, “earned media” growth
- Potential to dominate the specific “minimalist/hacker” niche

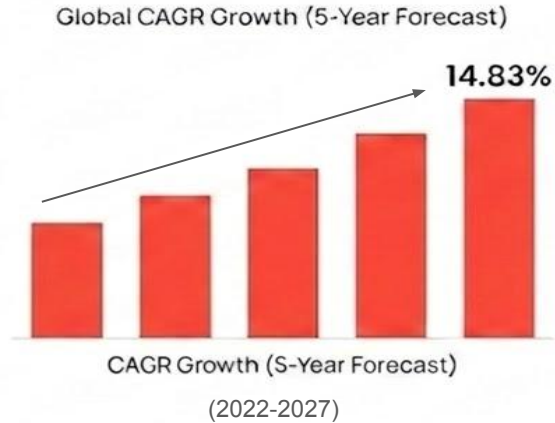
WEAKNESSES

- History of business failure
- Past marketing execution was poor
- Known product bugs & initial warranty limitations
- Limited financial resources compared to major competitors
- Niche appeal, not targeting mass market adoption

THREATS

- Intense competition from giants (Apple, Samsung, Garmin) with vast resources
- Rapid competitor advancements in battery tech, health sensors, & AI
- Economic pressures (inflation) impacting tech spending
- Risk of mainstream brands adopting minimalist features

Global CAGR & Regional Market Landscape: North America



North America Regional Segmentation



Diverse Players,
Niche Opportunities

SMARTWATCH MARKET COMPETITORS

Feature-heavy Smartphone Extension

“Do everything”
Apple, Samsung, Galaxy,
Google Watches



Fitness-focused Devices

“Optimize one thing”
Garmin, Fittrack Atria 2.0



Long Battery Minimalist Devices

“Do less, better”
That’s where Pebble lives



SMARTWATCH MARKET COMPETITORS

"Garmin is like a smarter Casio. Pebble is like a Gameboy-vibed Apple Watch." — internal team positioning

Brand	Battery	Price	Display	Target user	Pebble threat?
Apple Watch	18 hrs	\$399+	OLED	iPhone power users	Low — different segment
Samsung Galaxy	1–2 days	\$249+	AMOLED	Android mainstream	Low — feature-heavy
Garmin Fenix	14 days	\$599+	MIP/LCD	Serious athletes	Medium — battery overlap
Fitbit Sense	6 days	\$199+	AMOLED	Fitness beginners	Low — health focused
Pebble 2 Duo	30 days	~\$150	e-Paper	Minimalists / hackers	— (it's us)

Key insight: No competitor offers 30-day battery + open SDK + minimalist design at \$150. That's Pebble's unclaimed territory.

PEBBLE 2 DUO vs TYPICAL SMARTWATCHES

30-Day Battery Life

Charging less is better. Spend more time living and less time tethered to a wall.

Always-On e-Paper

Clarity over flashiness. Read your watch in direct sunlight without missing a beat.

Tactile Controls

Buttons for a practical world. Control your experience without looking at a screen.

Minimalist Design

A watch should not feel like another noisy screen on your wrist.

Core Utility

Time, notifications, steps, and sleep. Everything you need, nothing you don't.

Pebble stands out against Garmin and Amazfit by offering less: less charging, less distraction, and less complexity. Because most people do not necessarily need more features on their wrist.

WHY PEBBLE?

Evidence of user love

\$10.3M

Kickstarter 2012

Goal hit in 11 minutes · 68,000 backers

2M+

Watches sold

\$230M in total revenue

\$20M+

Kickstarter 2015

Repeat fanbase confirmed

Developer ecosystem

10,000+ third-party apps & watchfaces created by users
— fans didn't just buy the watch, they built for it.

Community kept it alive

After the Fitbit acquisition, users built Rebble.io to self-host Pebble servers — entirely unprompted.

"I saw another father with a Pebble Time on his wrist at the playground a few weeks ago."

— Eric Migicovsky, Founder (2022)

PROBLEM SPACE

Limitations of smartwatches

- Smartwatches can be too complicated
- Smartwatches are either too expensive or too limited in function
- 1-day battery life means not truly wearable
- No open, hackable option for tech-savvy users

What competitors missed

- Apple Watch — \$350+, 1-day battery
- Fitness trackers — too limited in function
- Kindle parallel: does less, wins on focus
- No open developer platform existed

Pebble's answer

7-day battery (e-ink)

Open SDK

\$150 price point

Notifications + music

Customizable watchfaces

Pebble's founder on the reason for their failure in 2013



“Our marketing efforts (outside of the Kickstarter campaign) were pretty awful. We basically dropped units into Best Buy and Amazon and expected them to sell accordingly.”

“We didn’t do any of the standard practices like synchronizing a campaign across all channels or building a strong influencer network.”

Takeaway:

- Great product $\neq$ automatic sales
- Kickstarter success $\neq$ real market demand
- Poor marketing execution can sink even a good product

VALUE PROPOSITION

For practical tech enthusiasts with an active lifestyle (who are typically 20-40 years old), the Pebble smartwatch allows them to stay connected through essential and lightweight smartwatch features without daily charging or feature overload, because it prioritizes long battery life, simplicity, and an open, developer-driven ecosystem unlike competitors with complex, resource-heavy app systems.

TARGET AUDIENCE

Target audience: Practical tech enthusiasts with an active lifestyle (typically 20-40 years old).

People who are tech enthusiasts, and who prefer focused, practical products over those with numerous features. They value efficiency, long battery life, open ecosystems, and products with a niche identity. Pebble appeals to them not because it is the most advanced smartwatch, but because it feels more intentional, customizable, and aligned with a functional mindset.

Practical Users

Tech-oriented users who value practicality over feature overload.

Function over Pure Style

Prefer functional design rather than flashy smartwatch aesthetics.

Value customizability

Interested in open-source, customization, and niche tech communities.

Purposeful

Want a watch that feels like a focused tool, not a mini smartphone.

Cultural Root

More likely to appreciate Pebble's developer ecosystem and drive for cleaner, functional design.

MARKETING GOALS

Main goal

Raise consumer awareness of Pebble as the leading minimalist smartwatch brand and increase sales.

01

**Earned
media
strategy**

02

**OOH
Advertising**

03

**Developer and
Community
reviver**

SOLUTION #1 – “EARNED” MEDIA STRATEGY



Problem: No budget to compete with Apple's advertising · Solution: Use authentic fans + micro-influencers

Rebble 100

Who	Top 100 Pebble community members
What	Free Pebble 2 Duo
Cost	~\$15,000
Ask	Honest content — no scripts
Timing	Months 2–3

Micro-influencers

Who	20–30 niche tech/lifestyle creators
What	Free Pebble 2 + commission
Cost	~\$10–15,000
Ask	"No distractions" & "30 days, no charging"
Timing	Months 2–4

Expected outcome

Who	Earned impressions
What	500K+ in 90 days
Cost	Total ~\$25–30K
Ask	Credible, authentic content
Timing	Ongoing

Why earned over paid? Pebble's identity is community-built. Paid ads contradict the brand. Fans are more credible.

SOLUTION #2– OOH ADVERTISING



- Promote Pebble as a practical alternative to feature-heavy smartwatches
- Minimalist visuals: Only show Pebble's brand name and in some cases, a visual of the product
- Target tech-oriented and practical users in high-traffic NYC areas
- Use clean, low-text posters to make Pebble stand out as calm tech in a noisy city
- Example headline: "Why do you need more?"

SOLUTION #3 - DEVELOPER & COMMUNITY REVIVAL

Why only Pebble can do this

- Open SDK — Apple Watch has no equivalent
- Rebble.io already exists
 - community self-organized
- 10,000+ apps built by fans, not employees
- Embers still burning on r/pebble & r/Rebble

REVIVE

Relaunch r/pebble + r/Rebble

Pin a "Pebble is back" announcement. Seed discussion with dev team AMAs and behind-the-scenes build updates.

EXCITE

Pebble Dev Challenge

Open competition for new watchfaces & apps. Prize: early Pebble 2 Duo units + feature on official channels. Low cost, high signal.

AMPLIFY

Developers become advocates

Excited devs post on X, YouTube, Hackernews — earned media that reaches exactly our target: practical tech enthusiasts 20–40.

"We inspired a passionate community" — Eric Migicovsky

DISTRIBUTION



Continue online distribution with a website exclusively for Pebble

Positioning

Niche Product + Limited Supply

Consistent

Limited supply doesn't align with mass-distribution

Minimizing Cost

Online distribution is significantly cheaper than retail which help with the low price yet stable supply

MARKETING PERFORMANCE EVALUATION

A. Brand Preference & Positioning

- Brand preference surveys (Pebble vs competitors)
- Sentiment analysis (positive vs negative mentions)

B. Conversion & Sales Performance

- Conversion rate (website → purchase)
- Sales growth vs target

C. Engagement & Community Strength

- Social media engagement rate
- Community growth (Discord/Reddit users)
- UGC volume (user-generated content)

D. Retention & Loyalty

- Repeat purchase rate
- App engagement (daily/weekly active users)
- Customer lifetime value (CLV)
- Churn rate

ENVIRONMENT ANALYSIS

A. Competitor Monitoring

Through monthly product scan reviews, monitor competitors

- Apple, Samsung, Garmin, and other fitness watch innovations

B. Technology Trends

Keep tracking tech developments

- Battery technology improvements
- Wearable health sensors (ECG, sleep tracking)
- AI integration in smartwatches

C. Consumer Behavior Trends

Continue monitoring changing consumer needs

- Demand for digital minimalism
- Health tracking expectations
- Price sensitivity changes

D. Economic & Market Conditions

Keep up to date with

- Inflation impact on tech purchases
- Smartwatch market growth rates